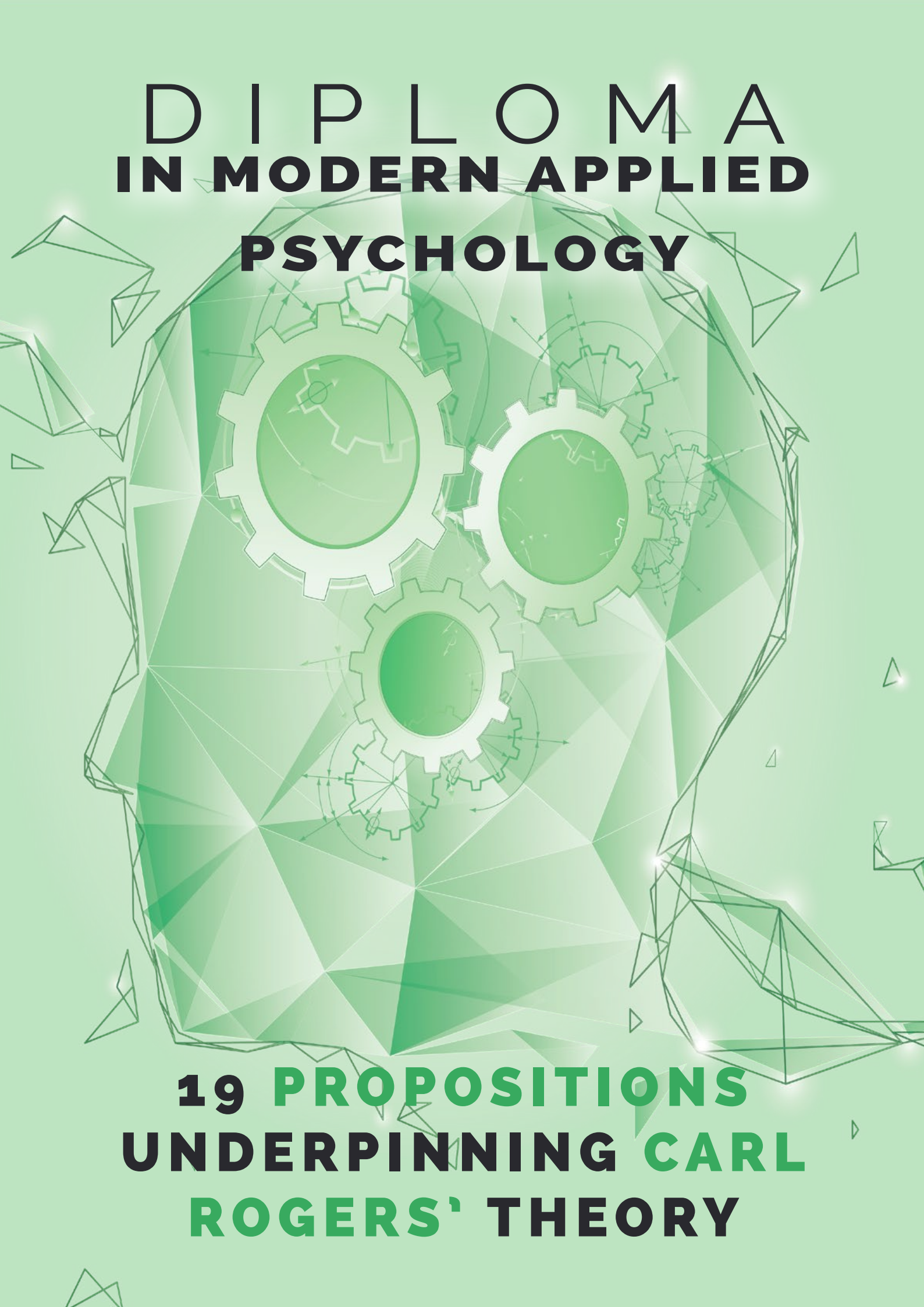


DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

The background of the cover is a light green color. In the center, there is a large, stylized skull shape composed of various shades of green and white. Inside the skull, there are three interlocking gears of different sizes. The gears are white with green outlines and contain green circuit-like patterns. The skull's surface is made of many small, overlapping triangles, giving it a faceted, crystalline appearance. There are also some faint, glowing lines and shapes around the skull, suggesting a network or a complex system.

**19 PROPOSITIONS
UNDERPINNING CARL
ROGERS' THEORY**

19 PROPOSITIONS UNDERPINNING CARL ROGERS' THEORY

1. All people exist in a continually changing world of experience of which they are the central point of focus and attention.

The only perspective can appreciate is their own; we can only ever work on making better sense of our own. We are all at the centre of our own little universe, meaning we can never understand anyone else's perspective and should never expect others to understand ours. If we want more from our relationships, we need to focus on becoming more flexible in our ways and being more suitable for other people (provided the change is suitable).

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

2. Individuals react to the changing world as it is experienced and perceived through their interpretation of it. This perceptual field is 'reality' for the individual.

People only respond to their interpretation of the changing world rather than the changing world itself, from perceptual threats to fears and hopes. Because we are aware that our responses and reactions are grounded in perception rather than reality, we need to become more articulate and mindful when communicating our ideas and emotions with others.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

3. People react (effect) as an organized whole to their experiences (cause).

Most people are eager to deal with the effects they experience in life than deal with and confront the causes of the effects. All negative and unhelpful behaviours and thought patterns have a cause which needs addressing, and whilst there can be methods and medications which can help alleviate some discomfort in life, supplementing oneself with treatments and managing the effects leads to a life of continued misery. Unless we identify and deal with the causes of our negative effects in life, we can never live peacefully.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:



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4. A part of each person's experience and perception gradually become defined as 'the self' until actualization has been reached.

People will conform with that which they identify with the most in order to justify their own actions and behaviours. Lifestyle choices and ways of being are perfectly normal, but those with a healthy relationship with who they are and what they stand for do not overidentify with what they do and how they are, nor do they feel any need to defend the way they are or explain it.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

5. As a result of interaction with society and others, the structure of the self is formed.

All of us are influenced by who and how we are raised in life, from the stability and groundedness of our parents to the attitudes and behaviours of those in our neighbourhood and society. Naturally, if we are raised in less than healthy environments by parents who aren't emotionally stable, secure or grounded, we ourselves grow up to emulate their behaviours because we don't know any better (or, we go to the other extreme and rebel). Our sense of self is drawn out of the conditions in which we were raised and in response to how we are treated and seen by others. We relate ourselves to every experience; we determine our self-worth, value and ability in life based on how others make us feel.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

6. The individual has one basic tendency and striving; to actualize and become whole.

All people are naturally gravitating towards that which is good (even if they're not there yet). We all naturally gravitate towards being a better person; none of us wakes up with the desire to hurt others or ruin someone's day. Whilst we may make mistakes, hurt people and say the wrong thing, none of us had the intention of doing so. The same law applies to others who hurt, undermine or belittle us. Self-actualisation is the ultimate vision we have of ourselves in the future, and the process of actualisation evolves out of the steps we take towards becoming that person.



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How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

7. The best vantage point for understanding human behaviour is from the internal frame of reference of the individual. A preexisting notion cannot define an individual experience.

You will never be able to understand another person unless you take the time to understand their frame of reference. Their frame of reference has sculpted who they are, how they behave and what they believe about themselves and the world.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

8. All behaviour is a goal-directed attempt by the individual to satisfy its motivational needs as experienced, through whatever means are perceived to be best suited.

This proposition follows on from the last. People's frame of reference explains why they justify what they do in life, even if what they're doing in life is morally wrong. Everyone is goal orientated, meaning that they will do things in order to ensure their needs are met first and foremost, even those who are selfless. We'll never understand why someone is driven to be the way they are unless we take the time to understand and unfold their frame of reference and work with them from there.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

9. Emotion accompanies goal-directed behaviour. The kind of emotion experienced relates to the perceived significance of the outcome for the maintenance and enhancement of the individual.

When people don't get the things that they're passionate about in life, they become emotional. Your emotional responses to failure, heartbreak or stress are not illnesses (unless you treat them and regard them as such). Your emotions, no matter how overpowering and unbearable they may feel, are always within your power and you can take back control over them if



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you try. It may take time, it will take hard work, but you can.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

10. The values attached to experience are experienced only by the individual, although in some instances, values are embodied from others, and perceived as if they had been experienced by those others directly.

Becoming a liberated individual means deciding what our priorities tastes, values and motives in life are (without external influence) and pursuing them with passion and drive. If we are still submitting to fears, insecurities and doubts, we are expressing immaturity and a lack of character. We can only find true value in life if we apply ourselves authentically in areas external to ourselves where we wish to add value to.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

11. Individual experiences are either, a) symbolized, perceived and organized into some relation to the self, b) ignored because there is no perceived relationship to the self, c) denied because the experience is inconsistent with the structure of the self.

Some people will dismiss the experiences of those they cannot relate to because they disagree with them. However, even if we disagree with someone on a fundamental level, it's important that we strive to become naturally empathic by nature, meaning that we stop dismissing ideas we disagree with or do not understand and take the time to disconnect our personal opinions when listening and communicating with others. Our goal should always be to understand an alternative frame of references. Experiences which are relevant to us are those which we can relate to ourselves, so it's important to find that connection when building relationships with others.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:



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12. Individual behaviours will always be consistent with an individual's concept of self.

If we do not have a strong concept of self (and insecure within ourselves), we will always compare ourselves to other people who we hope, in some way, we can either beat or pull down in order to 'beat' them and become greater than them in some way. However, when we choose a different set of values in life (values which aren't focused on serving the ego), our sense of self is less reliant on comparison and more on self-reflection and feedback from those whose lives we're impacting.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

13. In some instances, the behaviour may be responsive to abstract experiences or needs which have not yet been symbolized. Such behaviour may be inconsistent with the structure of the self, and in these cases, behavior is not 'owned' by the individual.

We can define ourselves in any way we want to, but we're all imperfect beings, which means sometimes we will slip up; we'll behave out of character or in a way which doesn't align with what we stand for. None of us is perfect all of the times, which means we cannot judge those for behaving in ways which aren't reflective of who we think they are.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

14. Psychological adjustment exists when the concept of the self is such that all the sensory experiences of a person can relate to on a symbolic level into a consistent relationship with the individual's concept of self.

It is only when our desire to change outweighs our desire to remain the same that we change our behaviours, attitudes and thought patterns. If we are not getting the connection we want in our relationships, we need to focus on changing ourselves and our approaches to our relationships.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:



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15. Any experience had which is inconsistent with how an individual has structured itself can be perceived as a threat.

Sometimes, the truth can hurt. Whenever we come across something which conflicts against our perception of reality and how we've structured ourselves, we become defensive. We all like to believe we're in the right, and we'd like to believe that we come across in the way we'd like to be perceived by everyone, all of the time. However, we can't control how people interpret who we are and what we stand for, because they will have pre-set notions about who we are and what we stand for based on what we are.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

16. The more threatening perceptions the individual perceives there to be, the more rigidly an individual will organize itself to maintain balance and structure.

When someone perceives that they are under threat, they will likely become more incongruent in order to become unconditionally accepted. This limiting way of conforming means the individual stops growing, as they have defined themselves according to a standard which they haven't naturally come to in their life, but rather, arrived by fear or pressure.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

17. When the individual perceives and accepts itself as one consistent and integrated system (including all his sensory experiences), then he becomes more understanding of other people and is more unconditionally accepting of them as different individuals.

There are some lifestyle choices and patterns of behaviour which many of us acknowledge are unhealthy and unhelpful. However, we can be opposed to certain lifestyle choices in life whilst still being completely for the people who abide by them. Demonstrating to someone that you have their best interests at heart sometimes requires tough love and frank honesty because those two factors are what drives change and sparks self-reflection in people.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:



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18. As the individual makes peace of his experiences and learns to respond well to them, instead of reacting emotionally to them, he replaces his current value system and breaks down his previous structure of the self. Thus the individual actualizes & becomes.

When we're willing to get over ourselves and get over our own selfish wants and needs; when we're willing to stop being right all the time and focus on creating a meaningful connection with others, we will become free, independent individuals with sustenance and character. Responses require contemplation, reflection and application to self.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

19. All individual behaviours are underpinned by positive intentions. – they must be in order for the individual to remain self-composed.

This controversial proposition claims that every action in the world is driven by a positive intention. It argues that people are behaving in a way which is right according to their standards, not your standards, which means there will be many actions in life which you cannot see as bad and some which you cannot see as harmless. We are all judgemental at times in life, but it doesn't mean our judgements are accurate or reflective of reality. This means which we must lay down all our judgements on a foundation of unconditional acceptance.

How do you interpret this proposition? What would be a helpful way to relate this proposition to yourself?:

